A Guide to Graphing Continuous Geometry in Racket

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Contents

1 Circles and Transformations

A circle can be defined in a few ways, but we will simply define its basic identity in terms of its standard equation:

$$x^2 + y^2 = r^2$$

The variables in a circle's standard equation are squared because it directly comes from the Pythagorean Theorem. Truly, when we say a circle is defined in terms of its standard equation, we mean that it is defined as all points (x, y) that are exactly a magnitude of r from the centre.[1] And the magnitude from the centre to any point (x, y) is:

$$\|\vec{u}\| = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$$

1.1 Standard Circles

Graphing a standard circle with its centre at $(0, 0)$. Let us present a predicament in which we are given the equation $x^2 + y^2 = 4$, and are tasked with plotting our circle in *Racket*. One might be tempted to simply set the radius to 4; however, the true radius of this circle is 2. One may wonder how we arrived at this value–do the exponents of x and y denote the radius of the circle, or did we take the square root? Remember that we established the radius r is equal to the magnitude:

$$r = \|\vec{u}\| = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2}$$

It is standard convention to square both sides of this equation for simplicity, which then yields the standard equation of a circle we introduced earlier:

$$r^2 = x^2 + y^2$$

1. It is common procedure to refer to magnitude instead as distance. However, it is more ontologically precise to explicitly name magnitude as the substance we are working with, because distance is an abstract measurement that exists only contextually rather than distinctly.

Withal, by transitivity of equality if $x^2 + y^2 = r^2$ and $x^2 + y^2 = 4$ then:[2]

$$r^2 = 4$$

Therefore, to find the true value of r , we take the square root of both sides:

$$\sqrt{x^2 + y^2} = \sqrt{4}$$
$$\sqrt{x^2 + y^2} = 2$$

What we can now conclude is that the equation $x^2 + y^2 = 4$ is simply a consequence of the Pythagorean theorem, but the magnitude r of our circle is the scalar value of 2.

1.1.1 Parametric Transformation of Representation

Visualizing a circle expressed in standard form through computational means is best done by converting its standard form to parametric form.[3]A transformation of a circle's standard form to parametric form can be considered a syntactic transformation–excluding it from what we would call topological transformations.[4]Formally, the conversion of implicit form to explicit form is known as an algebraic change.

2. Transitivity of equality is a fundamental axiom in math and logic, which states that if a quantity is equal to a second quantity, and that second quantity is equal to a third, then the first and third quantities are equal to eachother: if $a = b$ and $b = c$, then $a = c$.

3. A standard equation in geometry is known as an implicit equation, because it does not tell you exactly what y is, and thus, it is not a true function. Parametric form is what we call an explicit equation because it explicitly defines what the value of y is. It is possible to graph an implicit equation, but the lines are likely to be jagged and would require compensation of slopes.

4. The word *syntax* comes from koin Greek word *suntáxein* (συντάσσειν), which was specifically developed as reference to the grammatical order of words. Though, the english term we use is partly borrowed from the Latin *syntaxis* which itself was developed from Greek. Oxford University Press. doi:10.1093/OED/1603449563

Converting the implicit form $x^2 + y^2 = r^2$ to explicit form is first done by equivalent substitution of (x, y) to:

$$x = r\cos(t)$$

$$y = r\sin(t)$$

$$\text{Such that } t \in [0, 2\pi]$$

Since we already established that $r = 2$, we can finally write our explicit functions:

$$x = 2\cos(t), y = 2\sin(t)$$

$$t \in [0, 2\pi]$$

You might notice that our conversion is done in terms of the parameter $[0, 2\pi]$. One might wonder "Isn't a unit circle also restricted to $[0, 2\pi]$–is this related somehow?" The answer is that the parametric form is the unit circle–stretched by a scalar value, which in our case is 2. It may be useful here to acknowledge that a vector is composed of magnitude $\|\vec{u}\|$ (how far) and direction $\|\hat{u}\|$ (which way). Before we converted our implicit equation into parametric form, we only knew our magnitude $r = \|\vec{u}\|$. Now that we have the parametric form of our equation, we know our unit circle coordinates $(\cos(t), \sin(t))$–and this provides us with our circular direction $\|\hat{u}\|$.

We previously only acknowledged an algebraic change of implicit to explicit, but we can now acknowledge the subsequent stretching of the unit circle by magnitude of 2 as a scaling transformation. This is because when we changed to a parametric equation, we took our circular direction and scaled it outward by our specific magnitude, r .

1.1.2 Parametric Form as Dot Product

We must distinguish between the algebraic definition of the dot product, and the geometric definition of the dot product. The algebraic definition of a dot product is:

$$\vec{u} \cdot \vec{v} = u_x v_x + u_y v_y$$

This definition does not account for angles or shapes; hence, all it does is multiply and add lists of numbers. You would use this definition if you only knew the raw coordinates of two vectors $\vec{u} = (u_x, u_y)$ and $\vec{v} = (v_x, v_y)$. But what if we are handling geometric relationships? In that case, we would use the geometric definition of the dot product:

$$\vec{u} \cdot \vec{v} = ||\vec{u}||||\vec{v}|| \cos(\theta)$$

Such that θ is the angle between them.

Parametric Form in Lambda Calculus

In pure lambda calculus, we do not have pairs; instead, what we use are church pairs. A church pair is a function which itself takes another function and applies it to our two values. *Racket*uses what is called prefix notation. Prefix notation is a model of evaluation which evaluates a combination (+ 1 2), by applying the left most operator (+) and applies it to the operands (1 2). It is natural to assume that a church pair is equivalent to prefix evaluation. However, in the universe of lambda calculus, data does not exist; rather, we have functions. Data is something which can be considered inactive, while a Church pair is an active function that possesses your two values. And the only way for an operator to be applied on those values in our Church pair, is if given the operator by another function.

1.2 Graphing a Standard Circle in *Racket*

Here I will go over the actual code for graphing a standard circle with an origin at $(0, 0)$.

1.3 Shifted Circles

Here I will introduce shifted circles and the new standard equation of a circle:

$$(x-h)^2 + (y-k)^2 = r^2$$

I should have already clarified (according to a todonote) that x and y represent an infinite amount of possible coordinates for a given circle's boundary. I will be referencing the fact that I had already stated this in an earlier section.

2 Parabolas and Transformations

3 Hyperbolas and Transformations

When given the equation $x^2 = 4y + 8$, you start by doing smaller algebra:

> The goal here is to force an explicit equation by isolating y and x.
>
> $x^2 = 4y + 8 \longrightarrow x^2 - 8 = 4y$
>
> $\frac{x^2}{4} - \frac{8}{4} = \frac{4y}{4}$
>
> $\frac{1}{4}x^2 - 2 = y$

The form $y = ax^2 + bx + c$ is the most basic equation of a parabola.